

DockIQ.AI

Dock-Door Operator Support Initiative

Executive Summary | For Company Presentation | July 1, 2026

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The Problem

Forklift operators loading and unloading trailers regularly hit issues they can't resolve on their own — a damaged pallet, a barcode that won't scan, a temperature reading out of range, a mismatch between paperwork and product. When this happens, the operator has to stop working and either drive across the facility to find a supervisor or reach them by radio. Supervisors then have to travel back to the dock before the issue can even be assessed.

Separately, when an operator identifies a discrepancy — wrong SKU, short count, temperature deviation, mismatched lot — it's currently recorded on paper, by hand, disconnected from our warehouse management system. And the customer- and product-specific handling rules operators need (load patterns, lot rules, temperature thresholds) exist today as dense reference sheets, not something usable in real time while loading.

None of this is any single person's fault — it's a gap in our process and tools. But it's costing us time, consistency, and visibility every shift.

Why This Matters

↑ Idle time Longer trailer turn time	No triage by urgency Inconsistent issue handling	Paper-based, unsearchable No data on what's happening
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- Every minute an operator spends finding a supervisor is a minute the dock isn't moving — this directly affects trailer turn time and throughput.
- Supervisors respond to whoever reaches them first, not necessarily the most urgent issue — a safety concern and a minor scanning glitch currently compete for attention the same way.
- Discrepancy records live on paper today, which means we have no searchable history of what's actually happening across dock doors, shifts, or customers — no way to spot patterns or repeat problems.
- For cold storage specifically, some of these delays carry direct product-quality and food-safety risk (e.g., time-sensitive temperature deviations), not just an efficiency cost.

What We're Proposing

We're calling this DockIQ.AI — a tablet-based tool at each dock door that gives an operator, in one place:

- Their assigned load, customer, and paperwork details — pulled directly from the WMS, no re-keying (simulated with hypothetical data in the prototype).
- A one-tap way to flag an issue by severity, which instantly notifies the right supervisor with full context — replacing the walk-or-radio process.
- A digital discrepancy report, pre-filled with load data, replacing the current paper form.
- The applicable customer/product SOPs and a visual load-pattern guide, so fewer errors happen in the first place.

- A built-in knowledge base and AI-assisted chat, so an operator facing a familiar issue can get step-by-step guidance immediately and try to resolve it themselves — reducing unnecessary escalations and freeing supervisors to focus on issues that genuinely need them.

Our Approach: Build First, Then Present

We don't have company resources, budget, or access to real systems yet — so rather than asking for approval based on a concept alone, we're building a fully working, end-to-end prototype ourselves first.

- All data in the prototype — loads, customers, SOPs, discrepancies — is manually created, hypothetical sample data. Nothing in the demo will be real company or customer information.
- The goal is to walk into the company presentation with something the leadership team can actually see and use — not just a proposal on paper.
- Once there's real interest, that's the point where we'd ask for real WMS access, IT support, and a facility to pilot in.

What We'll Ask For, Once the Prototype Is Ready

- Time to demo the working prototype live to the wider team, not just describe it.
- If there's real interest: access to real WMS data/APIs, and confirmation of which systems (WMS, scanners, identity/login) we'd be allowed to integrate with.
- A decision on scope: one cold-storage facility/dock cluster as a pilot, before any wider rollout.
- Alignment with quality/compliance on what temperature and cold-chain records need to look like for audit purposes, since that shapes the design before it goes further.

Estimated Investment & Timeline

Figures below are directional, to be firmed up once there's real company involvement. Shown to give a sense of scale and pacing.

Phase	Timeline	Investment
Prototype (self-built)	In progress	Personal time only — no company cost
Pilot (1 facility)	TBD — to be scoped	TBD — depends on build-vs-buy decision
Full rollout	TBD — phased by facility	TBD — informed by pilot results

Proposed Next Step

Finish building the working prototype using hypothetical sample data, then schedule a live demo with the wider team — after which we can align on what a real pilot would need.